

The document is a 6-part research brief for your Stikaman launch plan. Let me execute it properly — running the full data pipeline across keywords, outliers, and competitors. Give me a moment to pull everything in parallel.

The document is a 6-part research brief — titles, keywords, competitor deep-dive, outliers, thumbnails, and 10 video ideas. Executing it all. Pulling the competitor channels now (Brofessor Stein, The Paint Explainer, EverythingProfessor) plus scoring your flagship title.

Competitor channels resolved. Now pulling their recent performance + content strategy to complete Q3, and validating keyword demand for the idea-generation part.

Excellent — I have the competitor and outlier data. Now let me execute the thumbnail strategy part (Q5): generating the 3 concepts and scoring them against the winning title.

Now generating the three thumbnail concepts from Q5 so I can score them.

Stikaman — Full Research Brief Execution

Here's the complete breakdown of your research brief, executed with live data. Starting with the headline insight, then walking each question.

 The #1 Finding: Your Format Already Wins — But Not the Way You Think

Your most direct competitor isn't The Paint Explainer — it's [Serious History](#) (Serious History, 819K subs). They do exactly your thing: stick-figure animation + dark history. And their engagement blows everyone else out of the water:

Channel	Subs	Avg Engagement	Recent Top Vid
Serious History (stickman!)	819K	3.3–3.9%	716K views
The Paint Explainer	1.97M	2.06%	796K views
Brofessor Stein	362K	2.12%	1.33M views
Qxir	1.25M	4.4–7.7%	243K views

Serious History's highest performers are dark human stories — revenge, vigilante justice, people snapping, pranks gone too far — *not* weapons explainers. That's the single most important strategic signal in this entire brief. The stickman format psychologically invites you to go darker and more visceral than photo-realism allows. Weapons explainers are the safe play; "when normal people completely snapped in history" ([When Normal People Completely Snapped in History](#), 337K views) is the growth play.

Q1 — Title Scoring 🔥

Scored your flagship and 3 alternatives:

#	Title	Score
 2	Every Banned Weapon in History Explained	90
 1	The Most Terrifying Weapons Ever Banned	93
 3	Every Weapon History Forgot to Banish	84
4	Why These Weapons Were Banned Forever	88

Weakest: "Every Weapon History Forgot to Banish" (84) — "Banish" is passive and non-visceral; nobody searches "banish."

Winner: "The Most Terrifying Weapons Ever Banned" (93). The word "Terrifying" front-loads the emotion and pairs with "Banned" to create forbidden-curiosity tension — the exact psychological trigger your "Every X Explained" dark-history audience responds to. Recommendation: lead with it; keep "Every X Explained" as your *series* suffix after a comma or on the end-card, not as the thumbnail title.

Q2 — Keyword Validation 📊

Your requested keywords, with two critical red flags:

Keyword	Monthly Vol	Competition	Overall	Verdict
72 every explained	496,519	48	71.8	● Monster — your format engine
65 weapons explained	32,179	38.5	65.0	● Strong, low-mid comp
57 war tactics	19,428	53.5	57.0	● Decent volume, high comp
62 military history explained	16,749	39.5	62.0	● Good
65 dark history explained	13,877	29.1	65.5	● Best comp-to-volume ratio
57 every war explained	11,209	49	56.7	●
60 disturbing history facts	9,900	39.4	60.0	●
65 banned books explained	8,935	27.1	64.6	● Great low-comp
55 morbid history	5,343	46.5	54.8	●
58 bullet types explained	3,866	35.5	57.9	●
80 stickman animation	1,521,464	38	80.2	● Huge volume for your niche

⚠️ Two red flags — do NOT build around these:

- [banned weapons explained](#) — confirmed search volume of 0. The exact-phrase, as-written variant has no search demand. Your title above is a *curiosity* angle, not a *search* play. That's fine for CTR — but pair it with [65 weapons explained](#) or [65 banned books explained](#) in tags for search coverage.

- [23 greek mythology monsters explained](#) — also confirmed volume of 0, so my recommendation would be not to anchor topic selection on this exact phrasing. Note that [Every Monster From Greek Mythology Explained in 12 Minutes81x](#) (Every Monster From Greek Mythology, 355K views) proves there's *audience* demand here — the search volume just lives under differently-phrased keywords. Judge this one on its own data.

Tag strategy takeaway: Lead tags with [65 dark history explained](#), [65 weapons explained](#), [62 military history explained](#), [72 every explained](#), [55 morbid history](#) — these give you search coverage without fighting full-competition headwinds.

Q3 — Competitor Deep Dive

[Brofessor Stein](#) — Brofessor Stein (362K subs, 212 videos, 80.5M views)

- Cadence: 2 longform/week, 100% longform, no shorts
- Avg views: 217K · Avg engagement: 2.12%
- Recent 90d top 5:
 1. How History's Deadliest Warriors Died — 1.33M views ([How History's Deadliest Warriors Died5.8x](#))
 2. The Most Disturbing Books You Shouldn't Read — 567K ([The Most Disturbing Books You Shouldn't Read3.4x](#))
 3. History's Biggest Unsolved Mysteries — 467K ([History's Biggest Unsolved Mysteries Science Still Can't Explain2.4x](#))
 4. The Most Dangerous Cursed Artifacts — 411K ([The Most Dangerous Cursed Artifacts2.4x](#))
 5. The Weirdest Nazi Facts — 307K ([The Weirdest Nazi Facts You've Never Heard2.1x](#))
- Pattern: Every top performer = "Darkest / Most Disturbing / Cursed" front-loaded. "How X Died" and "You Shouldn't Read/Shouldn't Watch" forbidden-curiosity formats dominate. 17-30 min videos.

[The Paint Explainer](#) — The Paint Explainer (1.97M subs, 162 videos, 302M views)

- Cadence: 1 longform/week, 100% longform
- Avg views: 475K · Avg engagement: 2.06%
- Recent 90d top 5:

1. The Most Disturbing Events in Space (Pt 2) — 1.67M ([The Most Disturbing Events in Space \(Pt. 2\)2x](#))
 2. The Most Disturbing Creatures in Each Ocean Layer — 1.21M ([The Most Disturbing Creatures in Each Ocean Layer2.6x](#))
 3. Ancient Greek Myths That Turned Out to Be True — 796K ([Ancient Greek Myths That Turned Out to Be True5.7x](#))
 4. The Most Disturbing Paleontological Discoveries — 560K ([The Most Disturbing Paleontological Discoveries Ever](#))
 5. The Most Disturbing Events in the Deep Ocean — 436K ([The Most Disturbing Events in the Deep Ocean](#))
- Pattern: "Most Disturbing [X]" is literally half his library. Series format with "Pt. 2" drives repeat-view loyalty. 11-16 min videos. Note: 13 videos in 90 days = slower cadence, higher bar — he can afford quality over quantity.

[Serious History](#) — Serious History (819K subs, 60 videos, 86M views) ★

YOUR DIRECT MODEL

- Format: Stick-figure animation + dark history (confirmed via channel keywords)
- Engagement: 3.3–3.9% — dramatically higher than Paint/Brofessor
- Recent 90d:
 1. More EXTREME Vigilante Justice in History — 716K ([More EXTREME Vigilante Justice in History](#))
 2. Pranks That Went Too Far in History — 401K ([Pranks That Went Too Far in History](#))
 3. Most Disturbing Revenge Stories — 400K ([Most Disturbing Revenge Stories in History](#))
 4. Most Epic Redemption Story: Robert the Bruce — 409K ([Most Epic Redemption Story in History | Robert the Bruce](#))
 5. When Normal People Completely Snapped — 337K ([When Normal People Completely Snapped in History](#))
- Pattern: Human psychology under pressure — revenge, vigilantism, snapping, redemption. Short hooky titles, story-first, 16-22 min. This is your blueprint. His higher engagement proves animation audiences *reward* visceral, emotional storytelling more than recitation of facts.

[Qxir](#) — Qxir (1.25M subs, 331 videos, 282M views, IE)

- Cadence: ~2/week, 6-10 min (much shorter than others)
- Engagement: 4.4–7.7% — highest in the set

- Recent: Times People Have Sued GOD (155K, [Times People Have Sued GOD | Tales From the Bottle1x](#)), He Shot a Ghost. They Sentenced Him to Death (153K, [He Shot a Ghost. They Sentenced Him to Death | Tales From the Bottle](#))
- Format: "Tales From the Bottle" — series storytelling with a distinctive narrator character + bottle narrative device. Content gap: Qxir's comedy-irreverent tone is the missing ingredient in the "Every X Explained" space. Nobody here mixes dark history + genuine humor. That's open territory.

[UCbrSe4uBleqJWeoynJAOsrw](#) — EverythingProfessor (605K subs, 81 videos, 43.9M views)

- No videos in the 90-day recent window (slower/newer restructure). Upside: 605K subs from 81 videos = 7.5K subs per video — the highest sub-per-video ratio in the entire competitor set. Proves that high-quality explainers compound by *per-video value*, not volume. Content leans knowledge/health/lifestyle, less pure dark-history.

Content gaps you can own:

1. Stickman dark-history is proven by Serious History, but nobody does it *plus* weapons/military mechanics with a clean "Every X Explained" catalog spine.
2. Humor + dark history (Qxir territory) is unclaimed in the animation space.
3. Series formatting — Paint Explainer's "Pt. 2" trick is proven but nobody in stickman format runs episode spines. You could build "Every Banned [X]" as an episodic DNA.
4. Higher cadence at 2/week — Brofessor runs 2/week at 217K avg; Serious History proves the format, you can win on output consistency.

Q4 — Outlier Detection 🚀 (Under-50K channels, 10x+ breakout, last 90 days)

"Every X Explained" format:

Video	Channel (Subs)	Views	VPH	Breakout
Every Strangest Trees on Earth Explained > 100x Every Strangest Trees on Earth	The Fact Explainer (2K)	162K	178	260.85

Video	Channel (Subs)	Views	VPH	Breakout
Every Marvel Universe EXPLAINED In Detail > 100x Every Marvel Universe Explained	Durmon (13.7K)	189K	166	112.91
Every Monster From Greek Mythology Explained in 12 Minutes 81x Every Monster From Greek Mythology	Mythological Man (3.9K)	355K	175	80.53
Every Erased Marvel Character Explained 43x Every Erased Marvel Character	Comicsology (10K)	88K	51	43.40
Every Famous Football Club That Disappeared, Explained 21x Every Famous Football Club That Disappeared	The 89th Minute (2.2K)	99K	90	20.64

Pattern: "Every" + *finite, listable, darkly fascinating category* + 10-13 min. The Fact Explainer hit a 260x breakout from 2K subs — the biggest in the sample — on *strangest trees* (i.e., NOT dark-history at all). That tells you the format itself is the magic, not the topic darkness.

Dark/Military history:

Video	Channel (Subs)	Views	VPH	Breakout
The Weirdest Weapons From Every Era Explained 47x The Weirdest Weapons From Every Era	ExplainTory (4.9K)	177K	93	47.18
The Deadliest Sword from Every Era Explained 16x The Deadliest Sword from Every Era	ExplainTory (4.9K)	143K	77	16.28
Why The Deadliest Confederate Guerrilla In History Was Erased From History Books 16x Deadliest Confederate Guerrilla Erased From History	kazun Dark (2.2K)	18K	10	16.05

Video	Channel (Subs)	Views	VPH	Breakout
U.S. Army Ribbons Explained: History, Meaning & Significance > 100x U.S. Army Ribbons Explained	Knowledge is power (1.4K)	10K	0.41	113.57

Banned/forbidden weapons:

Video	Channel (Subs)	Views	VPH	Breakout
The Forbidden Weapons Only MACV-SOG Was Allowed To Carry 20x Forbidden Weapons MACV-SOG Was Allowed to Carry	True Vietnam Docs (13.3K)	170K	14.7	20.40
11 BANNED Shaolin Strikes Kept Secret by Ancient Monks (Forbidden Kung Fu!) 66x 11 BANNED Shaolin Strikes	FORBIDDEN MOVES (2.9K)	49K	2.9	65.78
10 Forbidden Ancient Weapons That Once Made Empires Tremble 19x 10 Forbidden Ancient Weapons	Cloud 6 (5.7K)	41K	60	18.77

Key takeaways:

1. ExplainTory (4.9K subs) is your closest tactical model for the weapons niche — two breakout videos in 90 days ("Deadliest Sword", "Weirdest Weapons") both using the "from Every Era" spine. They're doing what you plan, with ~100K-180K views.
2. "Banned/Forbidden" is a proven breakout trigger — but the winners pair it with *specificity* ("MACV-SOG", "Ancient Weapons", "Shaolin Strikes"), never a generic "banned weapons explained".
3. "Erased/forgotten from history" is a fresh angle (kazun Dark, 16x breakout from 2.2K subs) that nobody in stickman format is covering.

Q5 — Thumbnail Strategy

Caveat: I attempted to generate and score your 3 thumbnail concepts, but the image-generation consent request timed out — so those tools didn't run. Let me know when you're ready and we'll

re-run them. That said, here's the data-driven strategy, which stands on its own:

Do animated thumbnails underperform photographic ones?

No — for *your* specific format, animation is an advantage. The proof: [Serious History](#) (stick-figure animation) pulls 3.3-3.9% engagement vs The Paint Explainer's 2.06%. In the *explainer* niche specifically, a consistent animated identity becomes a brand signal — viewers recognize the style before they read anything, and that recognition actually *raises* CTR because it builds a "this is one of THOSE videos I love" trigger. Where animation underperforms is when it's *inconsistent* or looks like a default AI output with no signature.

Stickman character vs realistic images?

Hybrid, biased toward the stickman when it's expressive. Your character is your brand asset — but a static stickman reads as "low-effort" if it's just standing there. The winning pattern from the outliers:

- Action — stickman in a dynamic pose doing something visceral (holding a banned weapon, mid-fight, aghast at something off-frame)
- Emotion/amplified expression — the whole reason Serious History engages 3.9% is that their characters convey *fear, shock, rage*. Your stickman's face/body language carries the emotion.
- Realistic elements as contrast — drop a photorealistic banned weapon or document *behind* the stickman. The contrast between your simple character and a gritty real object = instant curiosity gap ("why is that there?").

Best text patterns for "Every X Explained":

From the top performers' thumbnails in this niche:

1. The forbidden word in red — "BANNED", "FORBIDDEN", "CURSED", "BURIED" as 1-2 word overlay, bold, red with thick white outline. Matches your title-93 trigger.
2. The number/scale hook — "EVERY" in small caps above a massive subject, or "13" / "25" / "Every Single One" — signals comprehensiveness. The Fact Explainer's 260x breakout leans on this.
3. The count-up reveal — "Every Weapon..." with a progressively X'd-out grid (your Concept B instinct is RIGHT — the data supports it: [10 Forbidden Ancient Weapons That Once Made Empires Tremble](#)19x and [11 BANNED Shaolin Strikes Kept Secret by Ancient Monks \(Forbidden Kung Fu!\)](#)66x both use forbidden-item-grid thumbnails).

4. Split contrast (your Concept C) — proven in the niche; the legal-vs-banned nuke-vs-bullet split generates the exact moral tension your channel sells.

Text rules that apply to all: max 3-5 words, text fills $\geq \frac{1}{3}$ of frame width, thick outline/drop shadow, high-contrast background, clean negative space for the timestamp corner. Red on black + white outline is the highest-CTR palette for forbidden-topic content.

Bottom line on your 3 concepts: B (grid of weapons + red X's) and C (split nuke vs hollow-point) are the data-backed winners for *this* topic. Keep A (stickman + "BANNED") for lower-effort weeks, but make the stickman *threatening*, not passive.

Q6 — 10 Video Ideas for Stikaman

Grounded in your keyword data + the breakout patterns above. Confidence = 1-10 based on keyword volume + proven niche demand:

#	Title	Core Keyword	Vol	Comp	Confidence
1	The Most Terrifying Weapons Ever Banned	65 weapons explained	32K	38.5	9 
2	When Normal People Completely Snapped in History	60 disturbing history facts	9.9K	39.4	9
3	The Most Disturbing Revenge Stories in History	65 dark history explained	13.8K	29.1	8
4	Every Banned Weapon From the Geneva Convention, Explained	57 war tactics	19K	53.5	7
5	The Forbidden Weapons Only Special Forces Could Carry	62 military history explained	16.7K	39.5	7
6	The Deadliest Weapon From Every Era Explained	57 every war explained	11.2K	49	8
7	Cursed Artifacts That Killed Their Owners	55 morbid history	5.3K	46.5	7

#	Title	Core Keyword	Vol	Comp	Confidence
8	History's Worst Military Defeats Explained	57 war tactics	19K	53.5	6
9	The Weirdest Weapons From Every Era Explained	65 weapons explained	32K	38.5	8
10	The True Story of History's Most Erased Warriors	65 dark history explained	13.8K	29.1	7

Idea 1 is your launch video — it pairs your 93-scoring title with the strongest volume in your niche. Idea 2 & 3 are the Serious History-mirroring growth plays that drive subscription (high engagement, human-story emotion). Ideas 4, 6, 9 build your "Every X Explained" catalog spine. Ideas 7, 10 tap the "cursed/erased" breakout angle that got [Why The Deadliest Confederate Guerrilla In History Was Erased From History Books](#) 16x and [The Most Dangerous Cursed Artifacts](#) 2.4x their traction.

Your launch cadence: start with Ideas 1 → 2 → 3 in that order. That gives you: a weapons/CTR video, then two human-story videos that build the emotional connection that turns viewers into subscribers — the exact pattern that gets stickman channels to 3.9% engagement.

The Strategic Summary (read this)

1. Your format is validated at the highest level — [Serious History](#) proves stickman + dark history scales to 819K subs with the best engagement in the niche.
2. Lead with "Most Terrifying Weapons Ever Banned" (93 title score) — it's the launch vehicle.
3. Search vs. Click: your keywords ([65 weapons explained](#), [65 dark history explained](#), [72 every explained](#)) are strong volume/low comp. But "Every X Explained" titles play the *curiosity/click* game, not the *search* game — so pair them with strong tags, and let the "Most Disturbing/Darkest/Terrifying" front-loading do the CTR work.
4. Avoid [banned weapons explained](#) and [23 greek mythology monsters explained](#) as keyword anchors (0 volume) — use them as curiosity titles with different tag keywords instead.
5. Clone the human-story angle for your 2nd/3rd videos — it's where stickman channels earn loyal subscribers.
6. Thumbnails: bold red forbidden-word + your stickman in action, or the X'd-out grid. Re-run the image scoring whenever you're ready and I'll generate + score all 3 concepts.

Want me to turn Idea 1 into a full script — hook, story beats, scene-by-scene Remotion mapping — or generate those 3 thumbnail concepts now that we know the winning title? 🔥

Heads up: "banned weapons explained", "greek mythology monsters explained" showed very low search volume in this turn's keyword data — consider replacing them with higher-volume alternatives.